



Verizon and Amazon partner up
Verizon will now use Amazon's low Earth orbit satellites to provide 4G and 5G signals in the rural US. <https://digit.in/nov21-68>



Bye bye face recognition
Facebook shuts down its face recognition system which identified and tagged people in posts. <https://digit.in/nov21-71>

Sony HT-S40R soundbar

Sony fixed our biggest problem with budget 5.1 setups and it works really well

While we're all for a good 5.1 setup like the Sony HT-S20R, cable management for the rear surround speakers can be a bit of a hassle. It looks like Sony agrees and has done something unique with the S40R – made the rear speakers wireless... kinda. While wireless rear speakers are common in high-end soundbars, this is the first time we've seen them on a sub 30K soundbar. So, let's see how it performs.

BUILD AND DESIGN

Sony has the front right, left and centre channel in a single bar. The bar is wide and fits the length of a 43-inch TV. The bar itself has a very traditional Sony look. You have a grill up front covering the drivers and there are distinct demarcations for the front right, left and centre channels. The soundbar curves around the edges but it doesn't have too rounded edges which are nice. The soundbar is fairly slim and is designed for tight spaces below the TV. You can wall-mount it as well. The S40R's main bar connects to the subwoofer via a proprietary cable.

Moving over to the satellite speakers, this is where the story gets very interesting. Gone are the days of running the speaker cable below a carpet or hiding it beneath sofas! The rear satellite speakers connect to a wireless amplifier. All you need to do is connect the two satellite speakers to the wireless amplifier, connect the amplifier to a power source and you are good to go.

CONNECTIVITY

When it comes to connectivity, the Sony HT-S40R has optical-audio input, Analogue audio input (stereo



Price
₹29,990



BUILD	73
FEATURES	73
PERFORMANCE	69
VALUE	72

mini), USB type A, HDMI ARC, Optical port and Bluetooth 5.0.

PERFORMANCE

We played a lot of content from Blu-Ray movies to content on streaming services, gaming via the PS5 and much more. Sony is known for making good headphones, earphones and Bluetooth speakers, and the same legacy translates to its soundbars. You do get the slightly extra bass from the soundbar which will appeal to most. We reduced the subwoofer settings by a couple of points to remove the over present bass. Overall, music can be described as good from the soundbar and quintessential Sony, which is a good thing.

We connected the Sony HT-S40R to the recently launched 43-inch Redmi TV that has an HDMI ARC port. We connected a PS5 to the TV and used the console as our main media device. Considering the price of the soundbar, its performance is good. There is clear channel separation from the surround speakers although the channel separation from the front feels narrower.

While the soundbar has a bunch of presets like Cinema, Standard, Music, etc. We found keeping it on the Auto preset did a good job at judging the content and representing it the best. In the case of Ready Player One, the Auto preset gave the same experience as Cinema. Same for a lot of the action sequences in *Altered Carbon* on Netflix. When bullets fly all around the room, you can feel them. Another good example of immersive channel separation is when Batman enters the motorcycle chase sequence in the *Dark Knight Rises*.

VERDICT

On paper, the Sony HT-S40R looks like a successor to the Sony HT-RT3. Its biggest advantage is the setup for the surround speakers. They connect to a wireless amplifier that connects to the subwoofer wirelessly, eliminating the need to connect the surround speakers physically to the subwoofer as we've seen on the Sony HT-S20R. While the setup isn't truly wireless, it is very convenient. The overall sound output from the soundbar is very good considering the price point. It can produce punchy sounds for movies, is good for gaming and music lovers as well. Its build may feel a little plasticky, but it does not look cheap at all. It is convenient and easy to set up and comes with a 6 feet HDMI cable in the box for ARC connectivity. If you are looking for a good 5.1 soundbar under 30K, then you can definitely consider the Sony HT-S40R.

—Sameer Mitha

SPECIFICATIONS

TOTAL MAXIMUM POWER: 600W | SOUNDBAR WEIGHT: 2kg | SUBWOOFER WEIGHT: 7.8kg | AUDIO INPUTS: Optical-audio input, Analogue audio input (stereo mini), USB type A, Bluetooth, HDMI ARC | SOUNDBAR DIMENSION: 900 x 52 x 74.5 mm | SUBWOOFERS DIMENSIONS: 192 x 385 x 362 mm | HDMI INPUT: 0 | HDMI OUTPUT (AUDIO RETURN CHANNEL): 1 | HDMI INPUT SUPPORT: Dolby Digital, LPCM 2ch, Dolby Dual mono | OPTICAL AUDIO SUPPORT: Dolby Digital, LPCM 2ch

CONTACT

SONY | PHONE: 18001037799 | EMAIL: Web form | WEBSITE: <https://www.sony.co.in/>